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Project 4 – Hands-On Activity 8-1 – "Investigate Product Comparison Information"

For this project, I used a product comparison article from CNET, a website I found in Table 8-2 of the textbook. Website (URL): https://www.cnet.com/tech/computing/best-laptop/. The article is called “Best Laptops of 2026: Top Picks Tested by CNET.” It compares different laptops for different people, like students, gamers, business users, and people looking for a cheaper laptop.

The criteria used in the comparison include price, performance, battery life, display quality, weight, design, graphics, storage, memory, and overall value. The article also explains who each laptop is best for and who should probably not buy it. I liked that because it makes the comparison easier to understand.

Some additional criteria could have been included too. One is customer support and warranty, because that can really matter after you buy a laptop. I also think long-term durability could have been added, since many people want to buy a laptop that will last for a few years.

The evaluation method used in the article is a mix of lab testing and personal review. CNET explains that it uses benchmark tests, battery tests, gaming tests, and hands-on use. The reviewers also test things like the keyboard, screen, speakers, and the general experience of using the laptop. Then they give scores and explain the pros and cons of each one.

I think the results are both objective and subjective. The test scores, battery life, and specifications are objective because those are measured. The opinions about design, comfort, and overall experience are subjective because people may have different preferences.

I mostly agree with the results because the article explains the choices in a clear way. For example, CNET picked the M5 MacBook Air (15-Inch, 2026) as the best overall laptop because it has a good mix of performance, screen size, portability, and value. That made sense to me. I also liked that the article did not try to say one laptop is best for everybody. It gave different choices for different needs, which feels more realistic.

Overall, I think this was a good product comparison. It was clear, organized, and easy to understand, which makes it helpful for users trying to choose a laptop. I also think it would have been even better if it included customer support and durability.

Works Cited

Elliott, Matt. “Best Laptops of 2026: Top Picks Tested by CNET”. CNET, 18 Mar. 2026, https://www.cnet.com/tech/computing/best-laptop/